Paulo Matos

pmatostr@caltech.edu ◦ www.paulomatostr.com

Placement Director: Marina Agranov, magranov@caltech.edu

Placement Coordinator: Liza Bradulina, gradsec@hss.caltech.edu

Education

California Institute of Technology
Ph.D. in Social Sciences — *Expected June 2027*

California Institute of Technology
M.S. in Social Sciences — *2024*

Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú (PUCP)
B.A. in Economics — *2017*

References

Michael Gibilisco (Advisor)
California Institute of Technology
michael.gibilisco@caltech.edu

Alexander Hirsch
California Institute of Technology
avhirsch@caltech.edu

Jean-Laurent Rosenthal
California Institute of Technology
rosentha@caltech.edu

Maria Micaela Sviatschi
Princeton University
msviatschi@princeton.edu

Carlos Schmidt-Padilla
University of California, Berkeley
cschmidtpadilla@berkeley.edu

Fields

Political Economy, Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Crime, Formal Theory

Research

Job Market Paper

"We Have Your Back? Discretion in Police Discipline and Peer Effects on Officer Misconduct"

Does police discipline deter misconduct among an officer's peers? How does the discretion of disciplinary decision-makers shape that deterrence? I study these questions in New York City, where a civilian oversight board recommends penalties and the police commissioner makes the final disciplinary decision. In 2021, the NYPD constrained the board's discretion by requiring it to base its recommendations on standardized penalties, while leaving the commissioner's final authority intact. I find that a disciplinary recommendation reduces misconduct among other officers in the same police unit by about 30%, even before any penalty is imposed, and that final discipline produces an additional reduction of similar magnitude. The reform increased deterrence and reallocated it from the commissioner's final decision to the board's recommendation, allowing it to operate about a year earlier. More broadly, the findings show that the effects of disciplinary reform depend on how authority and discretion are distributed across decision-makers.

Working Papers

"Follow Your Lead? Institutional Challenges in Civilian Oversight of Law Enforcement"

"Trusting Each Other? Learning, Information Leakage and Optimal Incarceration Policies"

Work in Progress

"Mass Incarceration and the Expansion of Gangs: Evidence from El Salvador," with Felipe Goncalves, Carlos Schmidt-Padilla, and Maria Micaela Sviatschi.

"Can Community Engagement Policies Backfire?" with Victor Gamarra.

Book Chapter

R. Barrantes and P. Matos. "Who Benefits from Open Models? The Role of ICT Access in the Consumption of Open Activities." In M. L. Smith and R. K. Seward (eds.), *Making Open Development Inclusive: Lessons from IDRC Research*, pp. 219–248. The MIT Press, 2020.

Policy Reports

C. Kelling, C. Allen, E. Brault, and P. Matos. "Issues in the Spatial Analysis of Police Use of Force Data." *CHANCE*, 37(4), 11–17, 2024.

R. Barrantes, A. Agüero, P. Matos, and D. Aguilar. "Online Dis-trust? Relationships between Cybersecurity and Online Transactions." *TPRC 47*, 2019.

R. Barrantes, A. Agüero, and P. Matos. "Understanding the ICT Use Gender Gap in Latin America." *TPRC 46*, 2018.

Previous Employment

Senior Research Specialist, Princeton University, 2019–2022.

Research Associate, Innovations for Poverty Action, 2018–2019.

Research Assistant, Instituto de Estudios Peruanos, 2015–2018.

Research Assistant, Department of Economics, PUCP, 2014–2015.

Teaching

As Teaching Assistant

California Institute of Technology

- Investments (BEM 104; Fall 2025)
- Bayesian Statistics (Ec/ACM/CS 112; Winter 2025)
- Introduction to Economics (Ec 11; Winter 2023, Fall 2024)

Department of Economics, PUCP

- Regulation Theory (ECO381; Fall 2017)
- Industrial Organization (ECO320; Spring 2016)
- Public Economics (ECO225; Fall 2016)
- Microeconomics 2 (ECO263; Spring 2015)
- Introduction to Microeconomics (ECO113; Fall 2015)
- Introduction to Economics (ECO204; Fall 2015)

Conferences

2026: Midwest Political Science Association Conference; Southern California Political Economy and Institutions Workshop; American Political Science Association Annual Meeting; Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE) Seminar; Justice & Injustice Conference*; LACEA LAMES 2026 Annual Conference*.

2025: Midwest Political Science Association Conference; American Political Science Association Annual Meeting.

2019: 47th Research Conference on Communication, Information and Internet Policy (TPRC)†.

2018: 46th Research Conference on Communication, Information and Internet Policy (TPRC)†.

* Denotes scheduled presentation.

† Denotes presentation by a coauthor.

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

Stephen A. Ross Memorial Fellowship, California Institute of Technology, 2024.

"XX Annual CIES Research Competition", Consorcio de Investigación Económica y Social (CIES). Research grant (USD 16,000), 2018.

"XVIII Annual CIES Research Competition", CIES. Research grant (USD 4,000), 2016.

"Support Program for Academic Research Initiation (PAIN)", PUCP. Research grant (USD 3,000), 2015.

First Place, "IV Research Monograph Competition", Faculty of Social Sciences, PUCP, 2015.

"Visiting Student Scholarship", PUCP, 2013.

"Academic Research Award", PUCP, 2013.

Additional Information

Research Software: ArcGIS (advanced), Git (advanced), Julia (basic), Matlab (basic), Python (advanced), R (advanced), and Stata (advanced).

Languages: Spanish (native) and English (fluent).

Last updated: October 9, 2026